

02

New User Onboarding and Account Setup

Accounts, mailbox, licences, hardware and access for new joiners

Default priority: P3 Medium
(set due date to the start date)

Target response / resolution: Ready 1
business day before start date

Handled by: Tier 2

Scope

Use this instruction for a new employee, contractor, or intern request raised by HR or a hiring manager. All new-hire requests must be approved before work starts.

Related instructions: WI-09 Access Requests, WI-17 Offboarding, WI-18 Asset Management

Common symptoms

- Onboarding request form submitted by HR
- Manager requests equipment and access for an upcoming start date

Information to collect

- Full legal name, preferred name, job title, department, and manager
- Start date, work location, and employment type (staff, contractor, intern)
- Required applications, shared folders, and groups (use the role template if one exists)
- Hardware needs (laptop, monitor, phone, headset) and any special requirements

Resolution steps

- 1 Validate the request.** Confirm the HR approval and manager sign-off are attached. Check the start date and that no duplicate account exists.
- 2 Create the identity.** Create the user in the directory using the naming standard. Set the manager, department, job title, and location attributes.
- 3 Assign licences and mailbox.** Assign the licence bundle for the role. Confirm the mailbox is created and added to the correct distribution lists and teams.
- 4 Apply role-based access.** Add the user to the security groups defined for the role template. Anything outside the template needs separate data-owner approval (see WI-09).
- 5 Prepare the device.** Image the laptop, enrol it in device management, apply encryption, and install the standard software. Record the asset tag and serial number.
- 6 Set up MFA and credentials.** Generate a temporary password and share it with the manager by an approved secure method. Schedule MFA enrolment for the first day.
- 7 Hand over and verify.** On day one, confirm the user can sign in, send email, reach the VPN and key applications, and print. Walk through the self-service portal and how to raise tickets.

Escalate when

- Approvals are missing or unclear, or access requested conflicts with segregation-of-duties rules
- Hardware is not available in time for the start date
- Role template does not exist or is out of date

Resolution and closure

- Attach the completed onboarding checklist and asset record to the ticket
- Update the asset register with the assigned user
- Close after the user confirms day-one access works

Quick troubleshooting reference

Symptom	Likely cause	What to do
Request arrives without approval	Form incomplete or HR step skipped	Pause the ticket and ask HR or the manager for the approval. Do not start work.
Start date is less than two days away	Late notice from HR	Prioritize the laptop and account first. Tell the manager which items may be late.
User cannot sign in on day one	Temporary password expired or MFA not enrolled	Reset the temporary password and walk the user through MFA enrolment.
Mailbox missing from the address book	Directory sync delay or licence not assigned	Check the licence, force a sync, and allow time for the address list to refresh.
Access list does not match the role	Role template is outdated	Use the manager's list for now (with data-owner approval) and ask the owner to update the template.

Suggested wording for the user

Open	<i>"I am setting up your new starter. Could you confirm the start date and whether the HR approval is attached?"</i>
During	<i>"Your laptop is being built now. It will be ready one day before the start date, and I will share the first-day sign-in steps with you."</i>
Close	<i>"Everything is ready. Your new starter will get the credentials from you, and they can call us on day one if anything fails."</i>

Good practice

Do

- Use role templates to keep access consistent
- Record the asset tag and serial number against the user
- Test every account and device before handover
- Set the ticket due date to the start date

Do not

- Do not copy access from another user's account
- Do not create accounts before approval is attached
- Do not send temporary passwords by email or chat
- Do not forget the equipment collection plan for contractors

Worked example

HR submits a request for a new sales coordinator starting Monday. The request was received on the previous Wednesday.

Ticket note field	Entry
Issue reported	New starter on Monday, requires laptop, mailbox, CRM, and shared sales drive.
Checks performed	HR approval and manager sign-off confirmed. CRM access needs data-owner approval.
Cause	Standard onboarding request.
Action taken	Account, licences, and laptop prepared by Friday. CRM approval requested from the owner.
Result	Day-one checks passed. CRM access added Monday morning after approval.

Frequently asked questions

Q. What if HR asks for access that is not in the role template?

Treat it as a separate access request. Get approval from the data owner for each extra item and record it in the ticket (see WI-09).

Q. Can we create the account early so it is ready sooner?

Yes, as long as approval is attached. Create it disabled or without a usable password, and enable it on the start date.

Q. What should we do if the start date moves?

Update the ticket due date, tell the manager, and adjust the scheduled account activation. Do not leave activated accounts unused for days.

Analyst checklist

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| ☐ Validate the request | ☐ Set up MFA and credentials |
| ☐ Create the identity | ☐ Hand over and verify |
| ☐ Assign licences and mailbox | ☐ Ticket note completed using the standard template |
| ☐ Apply role-based access | ☐ User confirmed the issue is resolved |
| ☐ Prepare the device | |

Preventing repeat tickets

- Agree a minimum notice period of five business days with HR
- Keep role templates reviewed every quarter
- Hold stock of standard laptops
- Use a single onboarding form with mandatory fields